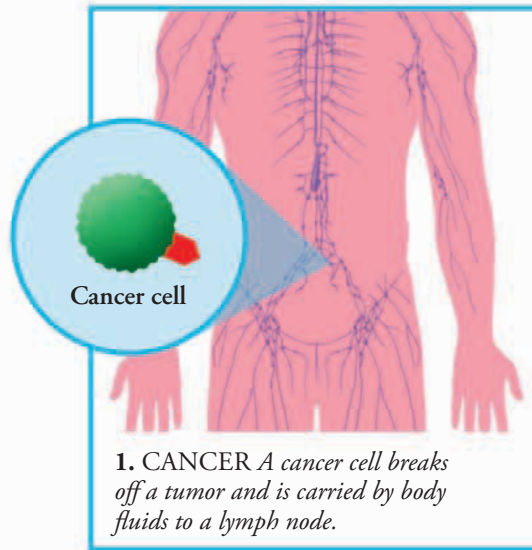
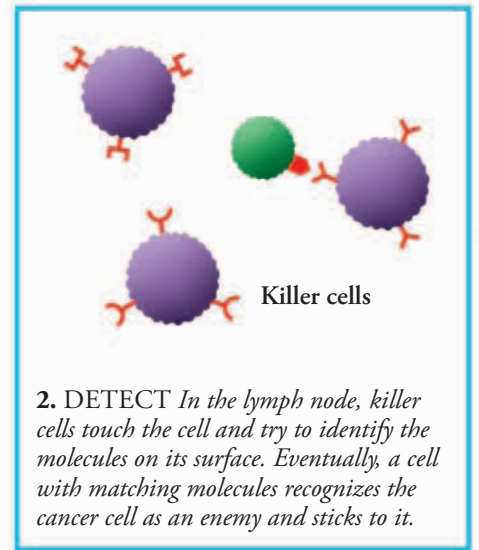


HOW KILLER CELLS WORK

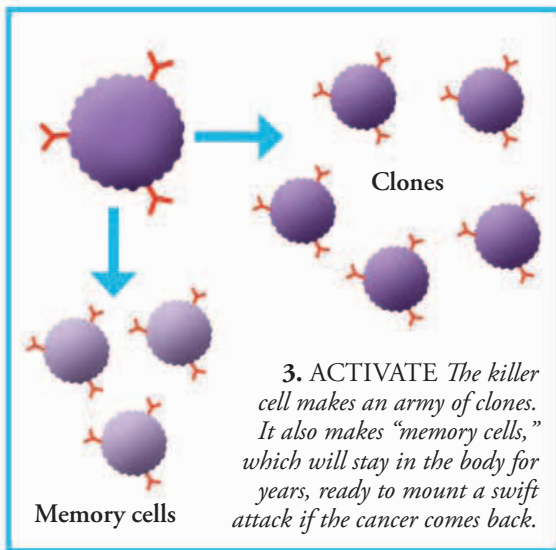
Killer cells work like antibody cells, but instead of releasing antibody molecules into the blood, they travel through the bloodstream themselves and attack their targets directly. While antibodies attack bacteria, killer cells specialize in attacking cancer cells and body cells hijacked by viruses.



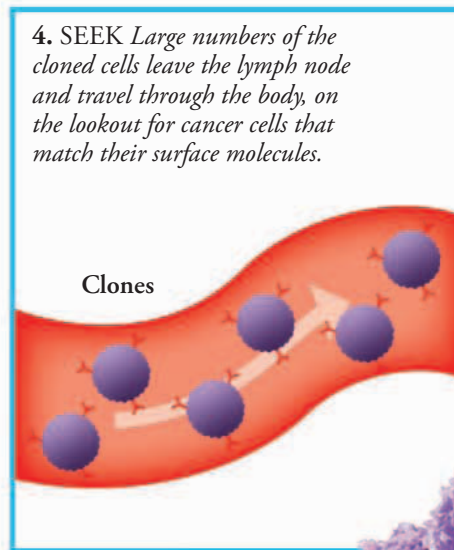
1. CANCER A cancer cell breaks off a tumor and is carried by body fluids to a lymph node.



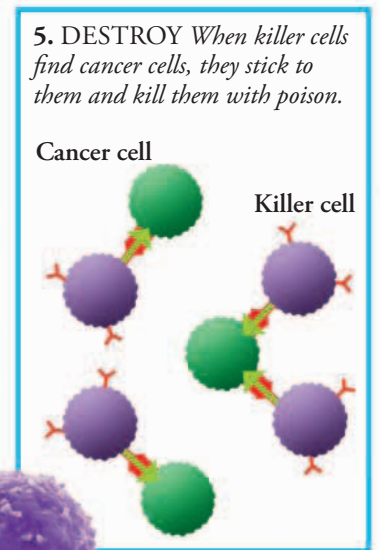
2. DETECT In the lymph node, killer cells touch the cell and try to identify the molecules on its surface. Eventually, a cell with matching molecules recognizes the cancer cell as an enemy and sticks to it.



3. ACTIVATE The killer cell makes an army of clones. It also makes "memory cells," which will stay in the body for years, ready to mount a swift attack if the cancer comes back.



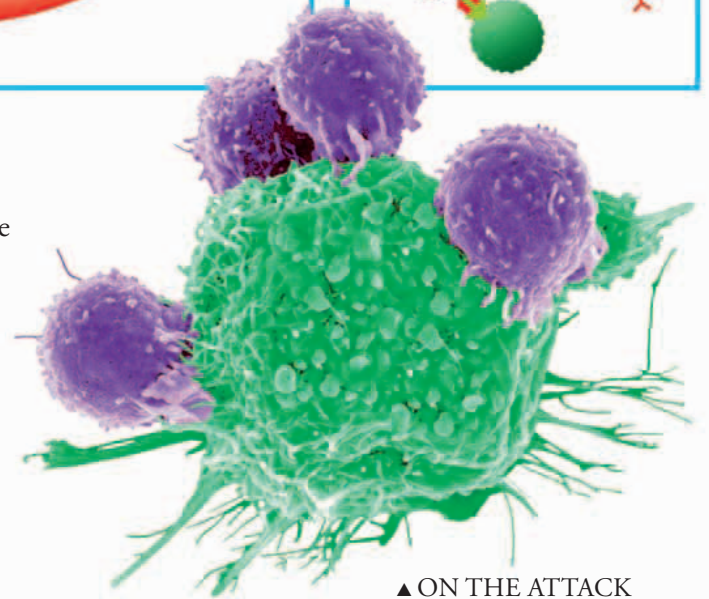
4. SEEK Large numbers of the cloned cells leave the lymph node and travel through the body, on the lookout for cancer cells that match their surface molecules.



5. DESTROY When killer cells find cancer cells, they stick to them and kill them with poison.

VACCINATIONS

Your body normally becomes immune to infections only after it has overcome them. However, you can also become immune by being given a vaccination. Vaccines contain altered germs that can't make you sick but still trigger the immune system, which then builds up reserves of memory cells.



▲ **ON THE ATTACK** Four killer cells attack a cancer cell. They will flood the cell with poison to destroy it.

◀ **VACCINE INJECTION** Vaccines are usually given as injections, but some can be swallowed instead.

